

Laser for reference?

Chinese scientists fired the Mianyang Laser into deep space to provide an accurate reference point to calibrate a telescope. http://dgit.in/PewPew_Pew



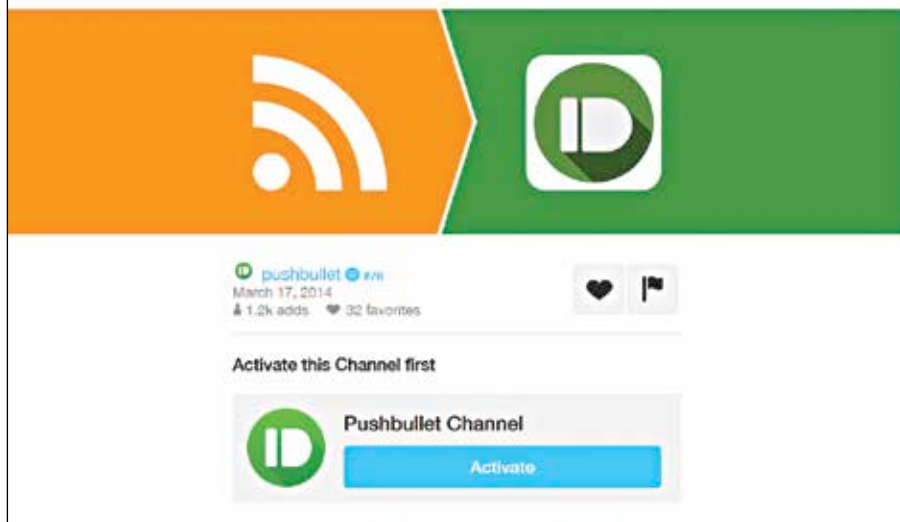
Keyboard Waffles

We love waffles, and a kickstarter project to make a keyboard shaped waffle has passed its goal <http://dgit.in/KeyboardWaff>

Feature

If new Humble Bundle announced, then send me a link

4 Browse Recipes



Get notified whenever a good deal pops up

Making Money

Teach a language

Those Sanskrit lessons that your mom made you take up in school are about to pay off. It's no secret that you can monetise your knowledge by teaching someone but there



Teaching pays pretty good

weren't platforms that bought a student and a teacher together. Now there are. italki is where you can sign up to teach or learn a language. Signing up to be a teacher is simple, you can set up a profile and wait for someone to approach to you. You then schedule a time slot and the teaching begins. There is a feedback system where your students rate your abilities which if positive would attract more students.

If you build up a good reputation, you can easily earn anywhere between ₹900 to ₹2000 with some teachers charging ₹4,000 per hour. Obviously, italki takes a cut which is currently 15% of your hourly rate.

Take up freelance jobs

We don't need to go into much detail over this one. Everyone has some skillset or

the other which can be monetised. In the previous section, we looked at monetising your language skills. There are sites like Freelancer.com and Elance where you can find some task or the other which is ridiculously easy for you to take care of and you get paid for it. However, it's a seller's market. Jobs are posted with a mention of how much the job poster is willing to pay and people bid on the posting. Whoever bids the least does not necessarily get the job, instead the job poster has full control over who gets assigned so any referrals that you'd have got from previous assignments makes you a more reliable assignee.

Amazon runs a similar service called Mechanical Turk which is a crowdsourcing platform for HIT (Human Intelligence Tasks). Though not as diverse as Freelancer,



There's something for everyone

MTurk is no small fry. It gives a job poster the option of having prospective assignee pass a test before being given the job.

It's Flipping time

Flipping refers to the process of buying something that can easily be sold off for a profit. This is a high risk method of making

money, the risk being that you might never sell a product to cover whatever you've invested. Take for example the recent exclusive sale phenomenon that many shopping websites have started. The Xiaomi Mi3 was available only on Flipkart and it has great hardware for the price. So the limited quantity and the whole lottery mechanism around it made it difficult to obtain. This meant that a lot of people were willing to pay a little extra to buy it from elsewhere so you had people buying the phone just so that they could auction it later. Some of these units sold for as high as ₹24,000 which is ₹10,000 more than the official price.

Step one in Flipping is to find something you can easily refurbish. eBay has tons of products which sell for a fraction of its original price because it is no longer functional. A mobile might not turn on, or an XBOX 360 has the RROD. A simple Google search tells you that flashing the mobile might bring it back to life and changing the heatsink on the CPU of the XBOX 360 is likely to fix the RROD. The expenditure involved in fixing either product is minimal and selling it would net you a decent profit.

If you are unsure about a certain item then there are plenty of forums where you could ask how much people would be willing to pay for it. And since these are the opinions of those who regularly flip items, it's a better estimation than the prices you'd find elsewhere. But be careful, it's quite likely that they'd swipe that product for themselves.

Once you've fixed it, all you have to do is figure out how to market it and how to price it so that it sells for a profit and sells quickly. Trying to maximise profit by playing the waiting game doesn't work out often. So you need to set a price that covers the cost price, shipping, taxes and all expenditures involved in flipping it.

We've essentially covered all the aspects of shopping online from finding the best deals, being first in the shopping queue and even sneakily sniping that auction at the last moment. Needless to say, you're going to save an awful lot of money with the aid of technology. Also, you're going to be earning quite a bit on the side too. You can thank us by shooting us an email and letting us know how much you saved. 